

INTERNAL REGULATIONS

CONTENTS

CHAPTER I: GENERAL PROVISIONS	2
Article 1: Purpose	2
Article 2: Scope	2
Article 3: Supplements	2
Article 4: Reservations	2
CHAPTER II: PROFESSIONALISM, HEALTH AND SAFETY	2
Article 5: Professionalism	2
Article 6: Health	3
Article 7: Safety	3
CHAPTER III: MANAGEMENT OF REGISTERS, ACTIVITIES AND STAFF	3
Article 8: Applications for Membership	3
Article 9: Applications for a change of status	3
Article 10: Inclusion in the Register of Honorary Members	4
Article 11: Participation in research projects and publications	4
Article 12: General Assembly	4
Article 13: Specialised bodies	4
Article 14: Support staff	5
CHAPTER IV: RESOURCE MANAGEMENT	5
Article 15: Collection of Membership Fees	5
Article 16: Expenditures	5
Article 17: Activities related to research or continuing education	6
Article 18: Prizes, grants and various awards	6
CHAPTER V: DISCIPLINARY MATTERS	6
Article 19: Active Participation	6
Article 20: Sanctions applicable to members of the Executive Board	6
Article 21: Universal sanctions	7
Article 22: Procedures	8
CHAPTER VI: ORGANISATION OF ELECTIONS	8
Article 23: General Rules	8
Article 24: Relevant time limits	9
Article 25: Voting by proxy	9
Article 26: Electoral Commission	9
CHAPTER VII: SUPPLEMENTARY PROVISIONS	9
Article 27: Communication	9
Article 28: Entry into force	9
Article 29: Amendments	9



CHAPTER I: GENERAL PROVISIONS

Article 1: Purpose

These internal regulations are established to supplement the bylaws of Stroke Action. They must always be read and interpreted in conjunction with the said bylaws.

Article 2: Scope

These internal regulations apply, without reservation or restriction, to all members of Stroke Action, as well as to patrons, volunteers, support staff and any collaborator, partner or service provider. They form an integral part of the bylaws and of any contract of employment, collaboration, partnership or service provision.

Article 3: Supplements

In the course of its activities, Stroke Action may enter into collaboration or partnership agreements or subscribe to national or international charters or protocols. Any clauses in such agreements, charters or protocols that are not included in these internal regulations shall be deemed to be supplements to them and shall apply in the same way.

Article 4: Reservations

Any Cameroonian law enacted after the adoption of these internal regulations shall repeal any provisions therein that are deemed contradictory.

CHAPTER II: PROFESSIONALISM, HEALTH AND SAFETY

Article 5: Professionalism

(1) Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action must conduct themselves in an exemplary manner both within and outside the association's activities. They must be hard-working, thorough, disciplined, honest, respectful of others, courteous, and must at all times dress appropriately and decently.

(2) Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action are required to maintain the cleanliness and integrity of Stroke Action's headquarters and all materials and equipment located therein. Those responsible for any damage or vandalism are liable to disciplinary action depending on the extent of the damage, without prejudice to claims for reparation or compensation or potential legal proceedings.

(3) Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action must exercise due care in their public statements and refrain from making judgements, remarks or expressing views that could be detrimental to the organisation's activities or its reputation.

(4) Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action must observe confidentiality rules regarding professional information to which they have access and take the utmost care to protect personal data.

(5) Discriminatory remarks, acts or behaviour are strictly prohibited within Stroke Action in any context, whether based on age, sex, religion, profession, race, ethnicity, language, marital status, socio-economic status, pregnancy, maternity, disability, political beliefs or any other distinctive characteristic. Offenders are liable to disciplinary sanctions commensurate with the seriousness of the offence, without prejudice to claims for compensation or potential legal proceedings.

(6) Acts of violence, abuse or harassment, whether verbal, psychological, physical or sexual, are prohibited. Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action are required to

report promptly to the Executive Board and the relevant authorities any such incident occurring within Stroke Action, regardless of the context.

Article 6: Health

(1) Members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action are encouraged to follow the recommendations of the Cameroonian Ministry of Public Health regarding the protection and promotion of individual and public health. In any event, they must not adopt or promote statements or behaviour that contravene the missions, activities or ideas promoted by Stroke Action.

(2) The consumption of alcoholic drinks, tobacco or drugs is strictly prohibited at Stroke Action's headquarters or during its activities. In the case of alcoholic drinks alone, any exception must be authorised in writing in advance by the Executive Board.

Article 7: Safety

(1) Standard fire safety procedures must be strictly observed. This includes, in particular, the ban on smoking, the provision of and training in the use of fire extinguishers, and ensuring that emergency exits are kept clear at all times.

(2) Anyone visiting the Stroke Action headquarters, for whatever reason, must record their arrival and departure times in the register provided.

(3) It is strictly forbidden to bring weapons, devices or products that are harmful to health, explosive or flammable into Stroke Action's headquarters.

CHAPTER III: MANAGEMENT OF REGISTERS, ACTIVITIES AND STAFF

Article 8: Applications for Membership

(1) As set out in Article 10 of Stroke Action's bylaws, any person wishing to join Stroke Action, either as an active member or as a volunteer, must submit a dated and signed application for membership to the President, accompanied by a photocopy of a valid identity document showing their date of birth and photograph.

(2) The application for membership is processed by the Executive Board, and a decision is taken by a simple majority of its members. This decision is subject to approval by the General Assembly in accordance with the procedures set out in Article 14 of the bylaws.

(3) The final decision must be made within 45 days as of the date of the acknowledgement of receipt. The Executive Committee may keep the reason(s) for rejecting an application confidential if deemed appropriate.

Article 9: Applications for a change of status

(1) In accordance with Articles 8 and 10 of the bylaws, active members may apply to be transferred to the register of honorary members. A dated and signed application, exposing the motives of the request, must be addressed to the President.

(2) A request for a change of status is valid only if the member concerned has paid their full active membership fee for the current year.

(3) The application is processed by the Executive Board, and a decision is taken by a simple majority of its members. This decision is subject to approval by the General Assembly in accordance with the procedures set out in Article 14 of the bylaws.

(3) The final decision must be made within 45 days from the date of the acknowledgement of receipt of the request. The Executive Board may keep the reason(s) for rejecting an application confidential if deemed appropriate.

Article 10: Inclusion in the Register of Honorary Members

(1) In accordance with the provisions of Article 8, there are three (03) ways of gaining entry to the register of honorary members:

- An express, motivated application submitted by an active member, approved by the Executive Board and subsequently by the General Assembly.
- The selection of an active member or a volunteer by the Executive Board, in recognition of services rendered.
- The appointment as a patron of an adult from outside the association whose status and reputation may help to enhance the association's national or international impact (see the bylaws, Article 9 and Article 10, paragraph 5).

(2) It is not possible for an external person to be entered directly into the register of honorary members without following one of the three pathways mentioned above.

Article 11: Participation in research projects and publications

(1) Participation in research projects is open to all, subject to their skills, availability and the needs of the project as defined by the principal investigator.

(2) Where a scientific publication is envisaged, discussions regarding the designation and ranking of authors must take place from the outset of the project and continue throughout its duration, so that the list and order of authors on the final article reflect their actual contributions in accordance with the rules laid down by *the International Committee of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE)*.

Article 12: General Assembly

(1) The General Assembly comprises active members, honorary members and patrons of Stroke Action. They are entitled to vote.

(2) Volunteers and support staff may attend General Assembly meetings on a voluntary basis, but they do not have the right to vote.

(2) The procedures for convening and conducting General Assembly meetings are set out in Article 14 of bylaws. Ordinary meetings are held twice a year, whilst extraordinary meetings may be held as often as necessary. The President shall notify members, patrons, volunteers and support staff of the date, time and venue at least 15 days before an ordinary meeting and at least 5 days before an extraordinary meeting.

(3) General Assembly meetings may only be held if the notice periods and procedures for convening the meeting have been observed and two-thirds (2/3) of the active members are present, provided that they are not expressly prohibited by the competent authorities.

(3) The functions of the General Assembly are set out in Article 14 of the bylaws.

Article 13: Specialised bodies

(1) In order to facilitate the fulfilment of its missions and as required, Stroke Action may establish specialised committees, commissions or working groups by decision of the Executive Board.

(2) The operating procedures for these specialised bodies shall be defined in due course and as and when required. These include, in particular, the process of establishment, their functions, their relations with the Executive Board and the General Assembly, any budget, their duration, and so on.

Article 14: Support staff

(1) Support staff employed by Stroke Action are subject to Cameroonian labour legislation. They are entitled to a standard contract, dated and signed, specifying working days and hours, the number of days of leave, salary, as well as professional benefits and obligations.

(2) Stroke Action is obliged to make every effort to provide decent working conditions for support staff and all its members.

(3) Expenses relating to the implementation of Stroke Action's activities may not be deducted from the support staff's salary.

CHAPTER IV: RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Article 15: Collection of Membership Fees

(1) Membership contributions for active members are set at 100,000 CFA francs (one hundred thousand CFA francs) per year, non-refundable and payable in a maximum of four instalments of 25,000 (twenty-five thousand) CFA francs. Consecutive instalments must not be more than 3 months apart. A surcharge of 1 per cent per calendar day of delay shall apply to the amount due for the annual or quarterly instalment.

(2) The treasurer shall maintain a register of membership fees and prepare the accounts on a regular basis. He must retain proof of each payment and make it available in the event of a dispute or an audit. Upon each payment, he must notify the active member concerned in writing (by email, SMS, WhatsApp message or other means) of the date when the next payment will be due.

(3) The primary method of payment for membership fees is bank transfer, which allows for full traceability of the transaction and identification of the source of the funds. However, other payment methods are permitted: Mobile Money transfers, cash payments at the counter, or cash handed over to the treasurer in exchange for a receipt.

Article 16: Expenditures

(1) The Executive Board is required to draw up a provisional budget for any activity or operation likely to generate expenses. This budget must be approved by a simple majority of the members of the Executive Board.

(2) Any purchase of goods or services worth more than 1,000,000 (one million) CFA francs requires the consideration of at least two quotations.

(3) All expenditure authorisations must be co-signed by the President and the Treasurer in accordance with the provisions of Article 18 of the bylaws.

(4) All expenditure incurred on behalf of Stroke Action must be documented on a receipt/bill, except in cases of force majeure.

(5) Where circumstances so require, an active member may pre-fund an activity or operation to facilitate the achievement of Stroke Action's objectives. Reimbursement of the amount disbursed shall be made against a valid invoice stating the reason for the transaction, the amount in figures and words, the place, the date, and the signature and, where applicable, the stamp of the service.

provider. Pre-funding is not permitted for amounts exceeding 100,000 FCFA (one hundred thousand CFA francs).

(6) In some specific cases, members, patrons, volunteers, support staff and partners of Stroke Action may receive compensation for their involvement in certain activities or for services rendered. The amount of the compensation set by the Executive Board must be approved in advance by the General Assembly.

Article 17: Activities related to research or continuing education

(1) In accordance with the provisions of Article 17 of the bylaws, Stroke Action may organise research or continuing education activities that may generate modest revenue, in particular through participation or registration fees.

(2) Where such activities are organised on Stroke Action's own initiative, any profits shall be paid in full into Stroke Action's account after deduction of expenses and various compensations.

(3) Where such activities are organised on the initiative of a third party or a partner who entrusts their management to Stroke Action (communication, invoicing, provision of premises), any profits shall be distributed as follows: 30 per cent to Stroke Action and 70 per cent to the initiator of the activity.

Article 18: Prizes, grants and various awards

(1) Stroke Action may, as required and depending on the circumstances, establish prizes, grants and other awards of all kinds to encourage activities likely to contribute to the achievement of its ultimate objective as set out in Article 2 of the bylaws.

(2) The Executive Board shall specify the conditions relating to the award and administration of prizes, grants and awards at the time of their creation.

CHAPTER V: DISCIPLINARY MATTERS

Article 19: Active Participation

(1) Article 7 of Stroke Action's bylaws stipulates that active members are required to participate actively (regularity and punctuality) in ordinary meetings of the General Assembly and are obliged to pay their membership fees.

(2) The same requirements regarding regular attendance and punctuality apply to members of the Executive Board with regards to attendance at monthly meetings.

Article 20: Sanctions applicable to members of the Executive Board

(1) Members of the Executive Committee shall be subject to the following sanctions in the event of a breach of their obligations:

- Being more than 15 minutes late for a monthly meeting: a fine of 1,000 (one thousand) FCFA
- Unjustified absence from a monthly meeting: a fine of 2,000 (two thousand) CFA francs. No fine shall be imposed for a single justified absence.
- Absence (whether justified or not) from two consecutive monthly meetings: a fine of 5,000 (five thousand) CFA francs
- Attendance at fewer than eight (08) monthly meetings per year: a fine of 5,000 (five thousand) CFA francs multiplied by the number of meetings missed to reach the quota of eight (08). This allows for a differentiated application of the penalty depending on the level of attendance previously demonstrated.

(2) The fine must be paid within 72 hours, failing which the amount will be doubled.

Article 21: Universal sanctions

(1) Members, patrons, volunteers and support staff may be subject to the following sanctions:

Name	Grounds or conditions for application	Comment
Suspension of active membership status, voting rights and the membership benefits described in Article 19 of the bylaws	Applicable only to active members. The sanction is automatic once it is established that membership fees are not up to date.	Rights are reinstated as soon as the member concerned makes the required payment. In the meantime, they retain the privileges of a volunteer.
Verbal warning	01 to 04 minor offences	Committed simultaneously or separately
Written warning	5 or more minor offences 1 to 4 moderate offences	
Deduction from pay	In the event that compensation is required for damage caused to Stroke Action's property, or in the event of absences exceeding 5 days without authorisation or valid justification, the total amount deducted will be proportionate to the value of the damage or the daily wage and will be spread out over a reasonable period.	Applicable only to salaried staff
Expulsion	05 moderate offences 01 Serious offence	In accordance with the provisions of Article 10 of the bylaws, paragraphs 8–12
Dismissal	05 moderate offences 01 Serious offence	
		This is equivalent to expulsion for non-member support staff of Stoke Action

(2) Misconduct is categorised as follows:

Grade	Description or examples
Minor offence	Arriving late (>30 minutes) at the workplace (for support staff)
	Expressing political views at Stroke Action's headquarters or during its meetings and activities
	Nonchalant, disrespectful service to customers/partners
	Use of materials or equipment belonging to others without prior authorisation or training
	Dressing inappropriately at workplace or during Stroke Action activities
	Raising one's voice, arguments or verbal abuse at workplace or during Stroke Action activities
Moderate offence	Failure to pay membership fees for one (01) year
	Failure to honour promises, commitments or contractual or statutory obligations
	Discriminatory behaviours or remarks at Stroke Action's headquarters or during its various meetings and activities, whether based on age, sex, religion, profession, race, tribe, language, marital status, socio-economic status, pregnancy, maternity, disability, political beliefs or any other distinctive characteristic
	Regular and unjustified absences from compulsory meetings or from the workplace (for support staff)
	Damage to the organisation's property

	Holding meetings at Stroke Action's headquarters for reasons unrelated to its missions
	Use of materials or equipment belonging to Stroke Action for purposes unrelated to its missions
	Bringing onto, consuming or distributing alcoholic drinks, tobacco or drugs at Stroke Action's headquarters or during its activities
	Carrying out duties whilst drunk or under the influence of drugs
	Disclosing Stroke Action's confidential documents to third parties without prior authorisation from the Executive Board
	Fighting in the workplace or during Stroke Action activities, except in cases of self-defence
	Endangering the lives of others, whether intentionally or through negligence (failure to comply with health or safety precautions; bringing dangerous materials or unidentified individuals onto Stroke Action's premises; drunk driving)
Serious offence	Failure to pay membership fees for five (05) consecutive years
	Embezzlement of funds intended for the association's activities
	Guilt established by a final court judgement (or by being caught in the act) for theft of property belonging to Stroke Action or to third parties, regardless of its value
	Guilt established by a final court judgement (or by being caught in the act) for facilitating or participating in acts of corruption
	Social behaviour detrimental to the association's activities or reputation
	Guilt established by a final court judgement (or by being caught in the act) in relation to acts of physical, psychological or sexual violence
	Support for activities or ideas contrary to those promoted by the organisation

(3) Regardless of any internal disciplinary action taken, Stroke Action reserves the right to claim damages from the person concerned or to take legal action, depending on the nature and severity of the harm suffered and the laws in force.

Article 22: Procedures

(1) The Executive Board acts as a disciplinary council. It receives and rules on complaints within 30 days. Any member of the Executive Board who has a conflict of interest or is implicated in the matter must recuse themselves.

(3) Each complaint shall be notified to the person concerned at least 10 days before the meeting of the Executive Board responsible for examining it. The person concerned may respond in writing in advance or choose to present their defence in person at the Executive Board meeting.

(4) Decisions of the Executive Board are taken by simple majority. Except in cases of expulsion, the result of the vote is final and takes effect immediately. A Letter of Notification, dated and signed by the President, must be sent to the person concerned within 72 hours..

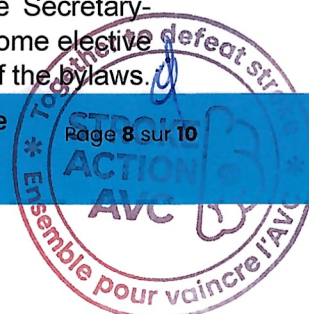
(5) Where the sanction imposed by the Executive Board is expulsion, the provisions of Article 10 (paragraphs 9–11) of the bylaws shall apply, and a General Assembly meeting must be convened to ratify the sanction.

CHAPTER VI: ORGANISATION OF ELECTIONS

Article 23: General Rules

(1) Elections are held to replace members of the Executive Board, in particular the Secretary-General, the Treasurer and the Auditor; the terms of the President and the Advisor become elective only in the event of a vacancy, in accordance with the provisions of Articles 15 and 16 of the bylaws.

Compassion - Abnégation - Intégrité - Professionnalisme
 Compassion - Dedication - Integrity - Professionalism



Article 29: Amendments

- (1) Any amendment to the internal rules of procedure must be approved by the General Assembly.
- (2) Any amendment shall come into force upon its ratification and shall repeal any previous contrary provision.
- (3) Any amendment must be notified to the administrative authorities by the President in accordance with the provisions of Article 7 of Law No. 90-53 of 19 December 1990.

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These internal regulations were adopted at the founding General Assembly meeting of Stroke Action held on 18 July 2026.

